

4 Donnie Darko

Donnie Darko is a complex psychological drama. No wonder it flopped when it released way back in 2001. However, over the years the film has formed a cult following among movie lovers who enjoy a film with a blend of supernatural and humane elements.

Sure, the movie might be too strong, for lack of a better word, for some. But there is no denying that beneath the confusion lies a story that keeps you thoroughly invested. Donnie



Darko follows a certain teenager Donnie who frequently sees visions of a rabbit Frank, who informs him of an impending doomsday. The film builds on this tension with such subtlety that a feeling of eerie dread keeps mounting. Donnie Darko with its cocktail of time travel science fiction and teen drama is a bright spot on science fiction genre classics. Watch it. It's a film experience unlike any.

6 Moon

Moon is the kind of smart and ingenious film that comes very rarely. The director of Moon, Duncan Jones, is David Bowie's son. The movie does have some serious science fiction pedigree! The setup is fairly simple. Sam Rockwell plays the last employee of a mining operation on the moon, accompanied only by a robot. But when he discovers something out of place on the surface of the moon things take a turn for the worse. The storytelling is so impressive and the visual effects so minimalist and hence timeless, that the film feels like the unfolding of a classic Asimov book. On the outside, even though the plot feels too thin to fill out an entire feature film, the director uses the struggle of a single man to tackle a variety of sci-fi concepts. The film stays with you and remains a fulfilling experience partly because of Rockwell's incredible and understated performance and partly because of how human and personal his character's story is, despite the science fiction underlining. Moon is a brilliant film, sci-fi, drama, whatever category you want to bracket it as.



7 The Man from Earth

If you are the kind of person that enjoys dialogue heavy films full of insightful discussions and lacking any visual razzmatazz than Man from Earth is just the right film for you. The film tells the story of a Professor who at his impromptu farewell party claims to be have been alive for more than 14 millenia. What follows is a to and fro discussion involving the Prof. and his colleagues each of whom contribute questions and views from his/her field of expertise. There is a historian, an anthropologist, a psychiatrist, a biologist



and even an archeologist, so there is a real breadth of knowledge on display. Man of Earth is a sharply scripted, engaging, and intelligent film, one that demands your attention and intellect. The film might not be everyone's cup of tea but there is no denying that Man from Earth demands to be watched. It manages to be a compelling film, without a single recognizable actor, or any effects or grand sets. That's no mean feat!

5 Children of Men

Children of Men is easily one of the best science fiction films of the last decade. Sadly though, the film never received its fair share of eyeballs. The film follows the journey of a man who ral-



lies to save a woman who is pregnant, a miracle in a post apocalyptic Earth ravaged by two decades of infertility. It is exquisitely detailed and the action scenes are shot with such technical artistry that you are transported right into the moment. Children of Men has an intriguing premise and it complements that intrigue

with breakneck pace and visual brilliance that makes for mandatory viewing. Expertly crafted and loaded with visual metaphors, ultimately, Children of Men is a film about the triumph of hope over a sense of futility. Oh, and by the way, Children of Men is directed by Alfonso Cuarón who made Gravity and shot by master cinematographer Emmanuel Lubezki, who won a hat-trick of Oscars for Gravity, Birdman and The Revenant.